BOTH SIDES OF THE HIRING TABLE

Software reads the résumé first.

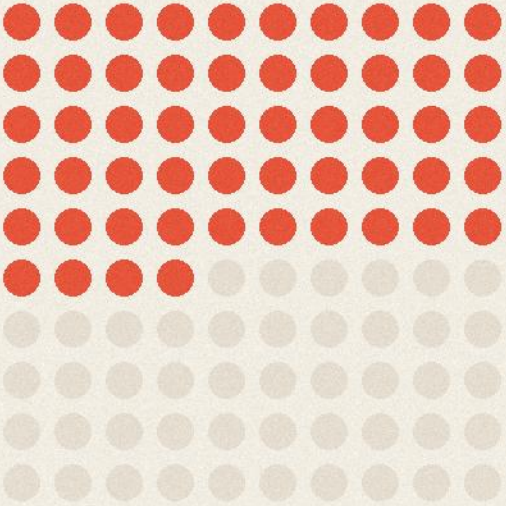
WHAT TWO 2026 SURVEYS SAY ABOUT ENTRY-LEVEL JOBS →

Sources: Northeastern AI & Society Survey (2 Nov 2026); AMS / Korn Ferry (20 Oct 2026).

BOTH SIDES OF THE HIRING TABLE

54%

of hiring decision-makers use AI for résumé review.



83%

of those in tech.

Applications per company have more than doubled since 2022, so software now reads the résumé before a person does.

Source: Northeastern University AI & Society Survey, n = 8,174 people with a say in hiring. 2 Nov 2026.

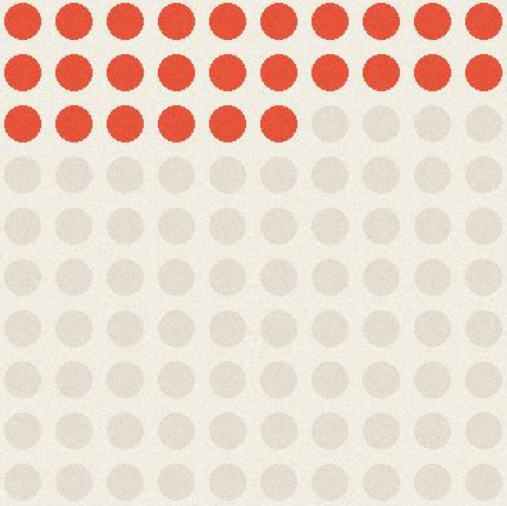
munna.

BOTH SIDES OF THE HIRING TABLE

Of those who say AI changed their hiring decisions:

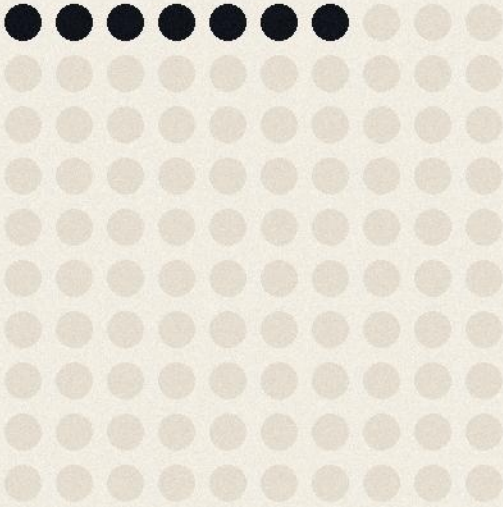
26%

HIRE FEWER ENTRY-LEVEL



7%

HIRE MORE

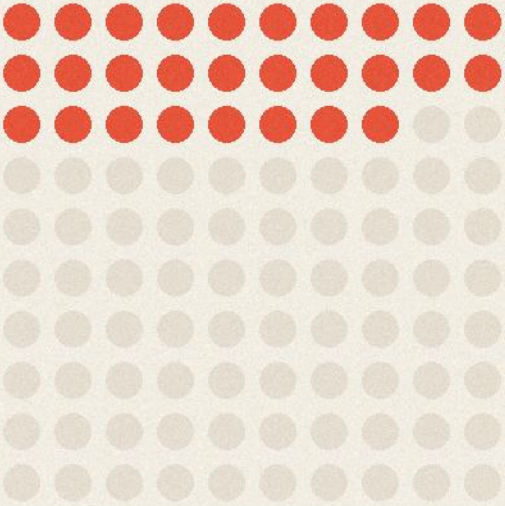


Source: Northeastern University AI & Society Survey, n = 8,174; about half said AI affected their decisions.

BOTH SIDES OF THE HIRING TABLE

28%

expect more output or higher-level work from entry-level staff.



THE BAR MOVES UP.

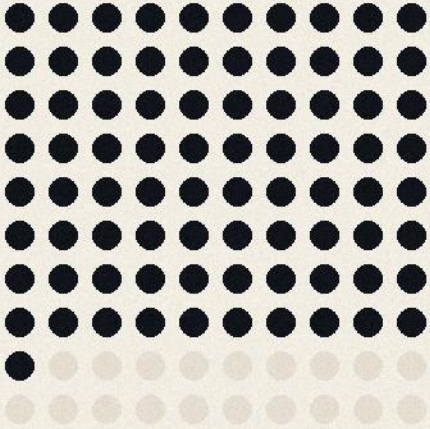
Even where hiring volumes hold steady, the job being hired for is changing.

Source: Northeastern University AI & Society Survey, n = 8,174. 2 Nov 2026.

A DIFFERENT SURVEY, A CALMER PICTURE

81%

of organisations plan to increase early-career hiring over the next two years.



76%

of talent leaders say entry-level jobs are not disappearing.

About half don't yet know what the change will look like.

Source: AMS / Korn Ferry, Class of 2030, 20 Oct 2026. 500+ HR leaders, 13 countries. Different sample from slides 2-4.

WHAT THEY SHARE

The first rung isn't vanishing. It's being redefined.

From doing the routine work to checking, testing and judging what AI produces.

If the routine goes to AI, where do juniors learn judgment?

Sources: Northeastern AI & Society Survey; AMS / Korn Ferry.
Different samples, read separately.